

HARSHAVARDHAN P

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Cybersecurity professional with 5+ years of hands-on experience in Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing (VAPT) and Vulnerability Management. Currently serving as Associate Consultant at KPMG India, with prior experience as Security Analyst at Deutsche Bank (Jan 2021 – Nov 2025). Core expertise in web application penetration testing, API security testing, mobile application security (Android), network pentesting, and Qualys VMDR-based vulnerability management. Actively explores agentic AI integration for security automation including Ollama with Kali Linux and prompt injection testing. Adept at identifying, analysing, and remediating vulnerabilities aligned with OWASP Top 10, CVSS scoring, and industry-standard frameworks.

WORK EXPERIENCE

KPMG India

Associate Consultant – Cybersecurity

Nov 2025 – Present

Bangalore, India

Web Application VAPT

- Conduct manual and automated web application penetration testing for enterprise clients across financial services and technology sectors.
- Identify and exploit OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities including SQL Injection, Broken Authentication, IDOR, SSRF, XSS, and Security Misconfiguration.
- Perform business logic testing, session management analysis, and authentication/authorisation bypass assessments.
- Deliver comprehensive VAPT reports with risk ratings, CVSS scores, proof-of-concept (PoC), and actionable remediation recommendations.
- Execute remediation validation and retesting to confirm successful closure of identified vulnerabilities.
- Support client security assessments and provide advisory to development and infrastructure teams.

Vulnerability Management (Qualys VMDR)

- Perform vulnerability analysis and remediation assessments using Qualys VMDR across Windows and Linux server environments.
- Review high and critical vulnerabilities, analyse potential system impact, and provide remediation guidance including patch updates, configuration changes, and mitigation strategies.
- Apply risk-based prioritisation using CVSS scores, asset criticality, internet exposure, and Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) framework.
- Create and track remediation tickets in ServiceNow and Jira with SLA timelines (Critical: 7 days, High: 15 days); validate fixes via re-scan and closure confirmation.
- Build weekly vulnerability dashboards covering severity trends, SLA compliance, and top vulnerable assets for security leadership reporting.

AI & Automation Initiatives

- Proposed and contributed agentic AI integration concepts for automating security workflows — AI-assisted recon, automated vulnerability triage, and LLM-driven report generation.
- Integrated Ollama (local LLM) with Kali Linux to enable AI-assisted penetration testing automation, reducing manual effort in reconnaissance and enumeration phases.
- Explored prompt injection attack vectors and contributed ideas on testing AI/LLM-integrated applications for security vulnerabilities.

Deutsche Bank

Security Analyst

Jan 2021 – Nov 2025

Bangalore, India

Web Application Penetration Testing

- Conducted in-depth manual and automated web application penetration testing across 15+ banking and financial platforms, identifying critical OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities.
- Performed authentication and authorisation bypass testing, session management flaws, business logic vulnerabilities, and input validation assessments.

- Utilised Burp Suite Pro and OWASP ZAP for DAST scanning with configured authentication methods, improving security testing coverage by 30%.
- Assessed cryptographic implementations (encryption algorithms, hashing, TLS certificates) and provided actionable hardening recommendations.
- Performed secure code reviews to identify security weaknesses at source code level, contributing to early-stage vulnerability detection.
- Conducted project-level threat reviews and defined testing scope based on business requirements, reducing test gaps by 15%.
- Delivered weekly VAPT reports and customised security summaries for cross-functional stakeholders, reducing issue turnaround time by 20%.

API Security Testing

- Conducted security assessments on REST and SOAP APIs — authentication flaws, BOLA, mass assignment, excessive data exposure, and rate limiting issues.
- Utilised Postman and Burp Suite Pro for API testing; mapped findings to OWASP API Security Top 10.
- Validated API security controls across integration layers for banking microservices and third-party integrations.

Other Security Activities

- Performed Android mobile application security testing using MobSF, Dex2jar, Frida, and Android Studio — analysed APKs for insecure data storage, hardcoded credentials, and weak cryptography.
- Conducted internal network vulnerability scans using Nmap and Nessus; identified misconfigurations and unpatched services.
- Executed SAST/DAST using Veracode, AppScan Standard, and SonarQube across the SDLC pipeline.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

VAPT: Web Application Pentesting, API Security Testing, Android Mobile Security, Network Pentesting, Manual Testing – OWASP Top 10

Vulnerability Management: Qualys VMDR, Nessus, CVSS-Based Prioritisation, KEV Framework, Remediation Lifecycle Management

Web & API Tools: Burp Suite Pro, OWASP ZAP, Postman, Nikto

Network Tools: Nmap, Netcat, Wireshark, Nessus, OpenVAS

Exploitation: Metasploit Framework, SQLMap, Hydra

Mobile Testing: MobSF, Apktool, Dex2Jar, Frida, Android Studio

Fuzzing: FFUF, wfuzz, Dirb, Gobuster

SAST / DAST: Veracode, AppScan Standard, SonarQube

AI in Security: Prompt Injection Testing, Agentic AI Workflow Design, Ollama + Kali Linux Integration, LLM-Aided Scripting & Reporting

Web Development: Landing Page Development, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Ticketing & Reporting: ServiceNow, Jira, VAPT Reports, Vulnerability Dashboards

Security Standards: OWASP Top 10, OWASP API Top 10, CVSS, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST, PTES, CWE

Operating Systems: Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Windows

Programming (Basic): Python, Bash, SQL, JavaScript

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Trained for CEH – Certified Ethical Hacker (EC-Council)
- Trained Security Tester – Ethical Hacking

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA)

2020

Sri Krishnadevaraya University, Ananthapur, Andhra Pradesh

Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com)

2018

Vivekananda Degree College, Anantapur, Andhra Pradesh

LANGUAGES

Telugu (Native) • English (Fluent) • Hindi (Fluent) • Kannada (Conversational) • Urdu (Conversational)